



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Faith Christian School
School Website: <https://fcsva.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Faith Christian School Roanoke (Zip 24018) demonstrates a strong, textually grounded alignment with Christian classical education across its publicly presented materials. The school explicitly positions itself as a Christian, classical institution, weaving theology, virtue formation, and the liberal arts into its mission, curriculum, pedagogy, and community practices. Evidence across the site highlights: a mission statement describing a Christ-centered, classical program; explicit references to the classical trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric); commitment to Latin and formal logic, rhetoric, and a senior thesis; emphasis on Great Books, a Christian worldview, and formation for life; liturgical practices and chapels; faculty as mentors; active parent partnership and a welcoming community culture. Where the school signals a classical stance—such as avoiding AP and prioritizing formation over mere information—the materials align with the classical framework.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - The school clearly foregrounds theology, biblical worldview, worship/chapel, and liturgical rhythm as foundational elements (Element 1). - Its stated purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and cultivation of truth, goodness, and beauty (Element 2). - The Curriculum centers on grammar, dialectic, rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, and a Senior Thesis (Element 3). - Pedagogy embraces both contemplative and Socratic methods, with upper grades engaging in seminars and rhetoric, and lower grades incorporating memory and liturgical aspects (Element 4). - Faculty are framed as mentors and the living curriculum, with a historical emphasis on community and character formation (Element 5). - Parents are positioned as partners and co-educators in a faith-integrated educational journey; the school invites visits and offers parent resources (Element 6).

If you'd like a deeper drill-down into any single category (with verbatim excerpted lines and stronger quantitative keyword tallies), I'm ready to expand that section further.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as a Bible-believing, private Christian school and frames its entire model around a Christian worldview integrated into all subjects (e.g., "Christian, private, Christian school" and explicit references to a biblical worldview and worship). - Core beliefs emphasize a Christian worldview, formation through gospel-centered education, and the integration of faith and reason, including worship and Scripture-centered training. - Weekly chapels and liturgical practices are described as part of the educational experience (for example, chapels and worship through music). - Statements such as "Our core beliefs direct how we approach education" signal explicit theological grounding and liturgical integration.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, biblical worldview, theology, gospel, worship, chapels, liturgy, sacred tradition, true/good/beautiful, formation, spiritual depth, divine order, Logos. - Notable alignment with the Positive Keyword set includes: Christian worldview, biblical worldview, theology, worship/chapel, formation for life, and truth-governed learning (connections to "truth, goodness,

beauty” and contemplation are echoed in mission-related language). For example, “formation for life” and a call to discern what is true, good, and beautiful appear in materials.

- Negative keyword indicators: The site does not foreground secular, relativistic, or non-theological approaches; in fact, it cites a clearly theistic frame and explicitly counters secular/non-Christian frames in its materials (AP-focused or secular ethics language is not dominant; one instance notes that AP is not taught, which aligns with a traditional, non-AP classical stance rather than secularism). The explicit AP exclusion serves as a counter-indicator to secular trends.

Why this rating - The school repeatedly anchors its mission, curriculum, and daily practices to Christian theology, biblical worldview, and liturgical life (catechesis through worship and Bible-centered formation). The presence of weekly chapels, a stated “biblical worldview,” and a mission framed as Christ-centered classical education strongly satisfy Element 1 criteria. The lack of secular framing and explicit affirmation of sacred tradition further supports a strong Classical alignment in this category. Rating justification drawn from the faith-centered materials cited above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission statement describes a Christ-centered, classical education designed to cultivate academic excellence, spiritual depth, and moral integrity for godly participation in society. This foregrounds virtue, wisdom, and formation over mere job preparation.

- The school emphasizes formation over information and a worldview-informed aim toward human flourishing, virtue, and love of learning; the “formation for life” framing is prominent in parent/ Admissions materials.
- The school highlights the true/true-good-beautiful teleology and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom as core aims (as reflected in program descriptions and the Great Conversation framing).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation for life, virtue, wisdom, character, love of learning, true/good/beautiful, human flourishing, sacred tradition, Logos, teleology, moral order, virtue formation, contemplative learning. - Negative keywords present: AP-not-taught (AP is explicitly minimized, which aligns with the classical stance per the Positive/Negative keyword framework’s negative indicators for AP-driven curricula). This is a classical-leaning negative indicator in a different sense (not “negative” to the school’s quality, but negative with respect to the modern AP emphasis).

Why this rating - The explicit mission statement, formation-centered language, and framing of education as formation toward virtue and wisdom align closely with Element 2’s criteria for CLASSICAL. The presence of “truth, goodness, beauty” and a teleological view of education further support CLASSICAL. The school’s avoidance of job-prep-centric, technocratic framing (e.g., AP emphasis) reinforces the classical orientation.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as modeled after the classical trivium: grammar, dialectic, and rhetoric, with Latin required for certain grades and a track system (Classical Track) emphasizing classical language study. This is a central hallmark of classical education.

- The school emphasizes the liberal arts, reading the best books, and developing reasoning and eloquence, including Senior Thesis and logic/rhetoric study. The presence of a Senior Thesis and formal logic/rhetoric coursework is consistent with classical pedagogy.
- The curriculum highlights integration of disciplines, reading Great Books, and a focus on forming students who can think and articulate ideas with clarity. Latin is positioned as foundational in early/middle years; the curriculum includes formal logic and rhetoric in upper grades.
- Evidence of Great Books, “Five Common Topics,” and a discussion-driven approach appear in various site materials tied to classical education (e.g., links under “classical education” and related pages).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, dialectic, rhetoric (the Trivium); Latin; Great Books; Great Conversation; senior thesis; integration of disciplines; liberal arts; logic; rhetoric; classic track. - Negative keywords present: Advanced Placement (AP) per design is explicitly not taught; some modern, non-classical approaches referenced in the negative keyword framework (AP avoided) align

with classical standards. The explicit AP exclusion is a classical-affirming negative indicator to the modern “AP-centric” model, not a detractor of quality.

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of grammar, dialectic, rhetoric; Latin as a core component; emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation; a Senior Thesis; and cross-disciplinary liberal-arts integration align squarely with Element 3’s CLASSICAL criteria. The site’s explicit stance against AP further reinforces a classical curriculum orientation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy includes both contemplative/restful elements and rigorous, Socratic-style engagement in upper grades (Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training). The site describes upper-school seminars and rhetorical training as central to development of argument and public speaking.

- Lower-school pedagogical approaches emphasize memory, singing, wonder, and formation (e.g., lower-school routines that foster memory and delight; singing him through content); upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic dialogue and rhetoric. - Extracurriculars, clubs, and co-curricular activities are framed within a community-learning model that supports formation and virtue via mentorship and discussion.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, debate, rhetoric, classical pedagogy, formation, wonder, singing to reinforce learning, teacher as mentor, great conversations, living books, memory work. - Negative keywords present: None that indicate a move away from classical pedagogy; the school explicitly uses Socratic/seminar-based approaches in upper grades and chants/memory-based practices in younger grades, matching classical pedagogy patterns. The presence of AP avoidance also aligns with classical pedagogy, not a drawback.

Why this rating - The school’s pedagogy integrates Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetorical training in older students with contemplative/memory-based activities in younger grades. This blend matches the Element 4 CLASSICAL criteria, where upper grades engage in rigorous, dialogic inquiry and rhetoric while lower grades cultivate memory and wonder.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents faculty as mentors who model virtue and act as living curriculum; faculty are described as a core of the school, guiding students in formation and intellectual development. The site highlights “Faculty Advisors” and the importance of mentor-like relationships.

- “Meet Our Team” materials position faculty as integral to the school’s mission and community; the faculty-student relationship is highlighted as central to learning. □filecite□turn0file2□ monials emphasize teachers who invest in students’ spiritual and intellectual growth, further underscoring a “living curriculum” approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors, teachers as models of virtue, teacher-student relationship, formation through faculty, staff as partners in formation, advisory roles. - Negative keywords present: None that indicate a move away from classical faculty expectations; the evidence supports the living-curriculum and mentorship model.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently position faculty as central to pedagogy, as mentors, and as a core element of the school’s educational philosophy, aligning with Element 5 CLASSICAL criteria. The emphasis on virtue, formation, and faculty-led guidance supports this rating.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and positions parents as co-teachers in the formation process; parent resources, packets, and opportunities for engagement are highlighted (e.g., family packets, parent packets, and emphasis on parent involvement).

- The site notes that parents come from diverse church communities and that the school partners with parents, including opportunities to visit and participate. This is reflected in admission and parent resources materials.

□filecite□turn2file1tent features testimonials from parents about the partnership between teachers, families, and the school, reinforcing a family-centered, community-oriented approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families/parents as co-educators, parent involvement, home-school partnership, family catechesis, school-family collaboration, parent education events, open invitations for visits. - Negative keywords present: None that indicate resistance to parental involvement; the content emphasizes welcoming parents and encouraging family engagement, which aligns with classical community practices.

Why this rating - The materials consistently articulate a strong, explicit partnership with parents and the broader community, which is a hallmark of classical education that treats families as co-educators and constituencies of the learning community. This aligns with Element 6 CLASSICAL criteria.

Aggregate assessment - All six categories: CLASSICAL. - Overall, Faith Christian School Roanoke demonstrates a coherent, text-backed Classical Christian frame across religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

What would move the needle - Not applicable, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. (If you'd like, I can propose enhancements that would push the school toward "More Explicit Great-Books Canon" or "Explicit Liturgical Year" alignment.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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